Energy resource scarcity is a concerning issue. Around the world, companies are looking for opportunities to operate independently of the energy grid by generating renewable energy themselves, ultimately helping to meet the global demand.

“There is every reason to believe that society will continue to use more and more machines and devices, therefore consuming more electricity,” says Mats Alvem, Global Environmental Manager at Sandvik “Meanwhile, as we switch from cheap, accessible, traditional energy to green energy, there’s a real possibility that clean electricity could become scarce. This is why, apart from the obvious benefits in terms of corporate social responsibility and reputation building, companies are looking to secure their own electricity supply for the future.”

Retail giants take the lead

The self-generated clean energy trend began among B2C corporations about a decade ago. More recently it has spread into the B2B segment.

One of the trailblazers was Swedish flat-pack furniture emporium IKEA, which started placing solar panels on the roofs of its buildings in 2011 in order to help reduce its carbon footprint. In 2019, the retail giant announced its investment in two large solar power plants in the United States and a wind farm in Romania, in addition to the 900,000 solar panels and 500-plus wind turbines it already operates. By the end of 2020, IKEA aims to generate more renewable energy than it uses worldwide.

In 2017, Apple opened its Apple Campus 2 headquarters, nicknamed “the spaceship,” in Cupertino, California. Apart from providing state-of-the-art facilities for as many as 13,000 employees, the 175-acre campus is also home to around 75,000 square metres of solar arrays, which provide 75 percent of the building’s daytime electricity.

Consumer pressure

It is no coincidence that leading retailers such as Apple and IKEA were among the first to blaze the self-generated energy trail. The most immediate rewards from this kind of initiative, Alvem explains, are usually related to public relations.

“These days, consumer-focused companies are under more pressure than ever to differentiate themselves from the competition,” he says. “Taking responsibility for the environment and having a strong sustainability profile is good for your reputation and also helps attract talent to the company.” Securing access to clean, affordable energy also makes good business sense, he says.

“Installing your own energy production is a long-term investment that only starts to benefit the bottom line once the payback period has passed,” he continues.

1) Responder las siguientes preguntas en ESPAÑOL.

   - ¿Qué puede llegar a pasar en la transición entre energía tradicional y energía sustentable?

2) Traducir los siguientes fragmentos al ESPAÑOL.

   - Energy resources scarcity is a concerning issue.
   - There is every reason to believe that society will continue to use more and more machines and devices.
   - The self-generated clean energy trend
   - Installing your own energy production is a long-term investment

3) Referencia contextual. Indicar a qué o quién hacen referencia las siguientes palabras o frases.

   - Themselves (línea 3) : _____
   - Their (línea 9) : _____
   - Which (línea 13) : _____
   - Its (línea 14) : _____
   - Which (línea 20): _____
   - He (línea 27): _____

4) Indicar los antónimos de las siguientes palabras
   - Abundance (línea 1)
   - Finished (línea 11)
   - Weak (línea 28)

5) Indicar los sinónimos de las siguientes palabras
   - Guarantee (línea 9)
   - Reported (línea 15)
   - Ultra modern (línea 19)

6) Completar el siguiente cuadro de conectores en ESPAÑOL.

CONECTOR	TRADUCCIÓN	TIPO DE RELACIÓN	IDEA UNO	IDEA DOS
therefore (línea 5)				
This is why (línea 7)				
In order to (línea 14)				
Such as (línea 23)				